



IMPLANTED WISDOM

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Post-Surgery: Soft and Non-Chewed Food Options

Now that your surgery is complete, you may wonder what you can eat. The progression of intake, from soft to regular foods again, is fairly straightforward.

Post-surgery, you'll probably begin with a clear liquid diet and progress to soft foods. Soft foods are generally considered those that can be swallowed without being chewed, or chewed lightly and cut using a fork. The soft food diet can be broken into many different types, including clear soft, mechanical soft, and thickened soft.

CLEAR SOFT FOODS

A clear soft diet contains any items you can see through but do not have to chew.

- Gelatin
- Broths

These items are easily digested and passed, causing no unnecessary post-surgical discomfort. Clear soft foods have another benefit of being low in fat content, so they don't stimulate excess gas production in bowels or trigger nausea. If your doctor has cleared diet progression, the next step will be a mechanical soft diet.

MECHANICAL SOFT FOODS

The National Institutes of Health offers meal suggestions and food ideas; however, the only set rule is that foods in this group do not require chewing.

- Blended fruit smoothies
- Milkshakes, ice creams, sorbets

Protein powders can be added for extra nutritional value. Plain meatless stews and soft-boiled vegetables are also allowable. If these are well tolerated, you can be creative and eat tender pasta, and scrambled eggs.

VARIETY IN A SOFT FOOD DIET

Once your care team clears you to progress, soft options like pasta, eggs, fish, and tuna add welcome variety while keeping your temporary bridge safe. When in doubt, ask your care team before adding a new food.

Reminder: A strict soft-food diet is essential while your implants heal. Your surgeon must clear you before returning to a normal diet.